

SE03 PLAN FOR HEALTHY RE-ENTRY | O (MAX: 1 PT)

Intent: Ready spaces for re-occupancy following situations requiring them to be vacant, taking into account necessary adjustments to policies, operations and protocols to support safer and healthier re-entry.

Summary: This feature requires projects to create and implement a re-entry plan that includes re-evaluation of existing policies, protocols and programs, risk inspections of building systems, frequent occupant communications, and flexible re-entry options to meet occupant needs.

Issue: In the U.S., the most frequent causes of evacuations each year are fires and floods; however, a wide range of other emergencies, from earthquakes and tornadoes to infectious disease outbreaks and explosions, can lead to mass evacuation and often may not allow for immediate re-entry.^{81–83} During the COVID-19 pandemic, many businesses worldwide were forced to close by government mandates; 82% of Chinese, 69% of UK and 62% of U.S. employees were forced to work remotely during the crisis.^{74,84–86} Extended closures post-emergency closures can lead to significant economic losses: business shutdowns from COVID-19 led to global recessions, increased the U.S. unemployment rate in the U.S. to 14.7%, and an anticipated 5.2% loss in global GDP in 2020.^{71,73,87,88} However, reopening and re-entry after a natural disaster can pose safety risks given potential aftershocks or recurrences and infrastructural and systems damage.^{82,89,90} In particular, re-entry during or after infectious disease pandemics can significantly increase risk of exposure; studies of the 1918 flu pandemic found cities that lifted closures, quarantine rules and distancing measures too quickly saw more deaths and slower economic recovery.⁹¹ During the COVID-19 pandemic, in many countries lifting stay-at-home orders and reopening businesses led to surges in COVID-19 infections and deaths.^{92–95}

Solutions: Careful consideration of re-entry timing and strategies is critical to supporting occupant health and safety in the aftermath of an emergency.^{96–105} Consulting with occupants on their re-entry needs and concerns, clearly communicating new roles, policies and protocols and offering flexible re-entry options will help mitigate occupant anxiety and support the inclusion, well-being and productivity of occupants.^{100,106,107} Assessing critical infrastructure systems and taking necessary actions to ensure those systems are functional after damage or extended shutdown is also crucial to facilitate safer and smoother re-entry.^{100,102,104} Finally, re-evaluating existing facilities management operations and workplace wellness policies to adapt to altered conditions post-emergency, and frequently communicating those changes to occupants, will help facilitate safer re-entry and create a healthier environment after re-entry.^{96–105}

Part 1 Part 1 (Max: 1 Pt)

For All Spaces:

Projects establish a plan for re-entry into the project after or during an emergency (e.g., natural disaster, public health emergency) addressing at minimum the following:

- a. Consultation with regular occupants before and after re-entry to understand their needs and concerns related to re-entry.
- b. Safety, compliance and risk inspections of water, mechanical, electrical, ventilation and life safety systems, including necessary actions to restart building and facility systems after prolonged shutdown and approval or clearance for safe re-entry, as applicable.
- c. A list of roles for those who will be responsible for overseeing the re-entry plan. While roles and contact information should be made available to an organization's personnel, it is not necessary to include this information in the plan submitted for purposes of verifying this feature.
- d. Re-evaluation and adjustment (as needed) of human resources, workplace wellness and employee support policies and amenities (e.g., use of common areas and shared spaces like wellness rooms, food provision, physical activity programs) to support a safer and healthier re-entry.
- e. Policy to support phased re-entry (as needed) offering part-time options, work from home flexibility and/or flexible schedules for all employees (as feasible), particularly for parents and caregivers who may have specific dependencies (e.g., due to childcare closures or a sick family member) and vulnerable groups (e.g., people with disabilities or who may be particularly vulnerable to infectious disease).
- f. Re-evaluation and adjustment of facilities management policies and organizational protocols to support

a safer and healthier re-entry, including but not limited to:

1. Crowd management and spacing and physical distancing of individuals.
 2. Heightened security measures (e.g., screening, security personnel).
 3. Access to personal protective equipment (PPE).
 4. Additional sanitization supplies and other cleaning or maintenance protocols.
- g. Contingency planning and re-closure measures should the same hazard that forced initial closure re-occur.
- h. Frequent communications through multiple methods (e.g., emails, signage, trainings) to all relevant stakeholders, including (as applicable) employees, occupants, residents, facilities management team, contractors and community members, on: the re-entry plan; new or altered policies; operations and procedures; relevant local-, state-, national- or global-level re-entry guidelines and how the project will address occupant health and safety concerns.
- i. Evaluation and incorporation of re-entry guidelines (as available) provided by a relevant local-, regional- or global-level emergency response agency (e.g., WHO, government emergency management agency or equivalent) into the plan, and adherence to instructions provided by that agency during re-entry.

Note: This feature is a beta strategy and has an additional documentation requirement (beta feature feedback form). The feedback form supports IWBI in developing new features that are effective and applicable to projects around the world.